

Notes (Week 7 Monday)

These are the notes I wrote during the lecture.

A relation $\mathcal{R}$ such that:

$$(s, s') \in \mathcal{R}$$

this means that, if we start from
the initial state s ,
a *possible* final result of
running the program is s'

We're using "state machines"
and "transition systems"
as synonyms

The relations we've been looking
at so far (e.g. in assignment 1)
are "big-step" relations:

$$(s, s') \in \mathcal{R}$$

one jump through the relation
takes us immediately from
initial to final state

In transition systems,
we consider "small-step" relations
one step through the relation
represents one computation step
which isn't necessarily the whole
computation

Bounded counter system:

$$S = \{0, 1, \dots, 99, \text{overflow}\}$$

Transition relation

$$\rightarrow \subseteq S \times S$$

$$\begin{aligned} \rightarrow = & \{(x, x+1) : x \leq 98\} \\ & \cup \{(99, \text{overflow})\} \\ & \cup \{(\text{overflow}, \text{overflow})\} \end{aligned}$$

Very often, when we model programs,

it's enough to track the values
of variables (let's say)

$$s \rightarrow s'$$

Also very often, you distinguish
between (internal) state
and externally observable events.
You'd put the events on the labels,
and the internal stuff in the states.

```
void hi() {
    printf("Hello world!");
}

void hello() {
    int x = 1;
    if(Math.Random() < .5)
        printf("Hello world!");
    else {
        x++;
        printf("Hello world!");
    }
}
```

We might model these as transition systems
where the labels are:

print_hello for the printf event
 τ or no label for unobservable events

The definition of determinism in an
unlabelled transition system is:

for every state s , there is at most one s'
such that $s \rightarrow s'$

For *labelled* transition systems:

for every state s and label α , there is at
most one s' such that

$$s \xrightarrow{\alpha} s'$$

```
(0,0) → (0,3) → (3,0) →
(3,3) → (5,1) → (0,1) → (1,0)
(1,3) → (4,0)
```

The counter transition system

Here are some runs (from $\emptyset$):

$\emptyset, 1, 2, 3, 4, 5$

$\emptyset$

$\emptyset, 1, 2, 3, \dots, 99, \text{overflow}, \text{overflow}, \dots$

^ the last one is the only maximal run

If R is a relation,

then R^* is the

*reflexive and transitive closure of R

Defined inductively by the following rules:

$(x, x) \in R^*$

If $(x, y) \in R$ and $(y, z) \in R^*$

then $(x, z) \in R^*$

If R is a transition relation, then

$x R^* y$ means

"in $\emptyset$ or more steps, we can get from x to y "

Safety and liveness properties are

not moral judgements

Safety "something bad will never happen"

Liveness "something good will happen"

Mostly ignore the words "bad" and "good"

I will come home tonight,

and find a chocolate cake in my fridge

I will come home tonight,

and find something super gross in my fridge

^ both of these are liveness properties

In order to have a useful system,

you want it to satisfy both safety

and liveness properties.

A system that does nothing

satisfies every safety property.

If you only specify a liveness property,

you can't rule out undesired behaviour

Q: How is this a safety property?

If the program terminates, then $y=x!$

A: it can be equivalently stated as follows:

The program will never reach a final state
where $y \neq x$!

Safety:

A safety property can be falsified
by a finite prefix of a behaviour

Liveness:

It is never too late to satisfy the
liveness property.

Any finite prefix of a behaviour
can be extended into one that satisfies
the liveness property.

When I come home,
I'll drop on the couch and drink a beer

1. this is a liveness property

When I come home,
I'll **eventually** drop on the couch and drink a beer

2. this is a safety property

When I come home,
I'll **immediately** drop on the couch and drink a beer